Sam Finard

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EDUCATION

New York University December 2024

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science, CS GPA: 3.5

- Minor in Mathematics and Music
- Relevant coursework: Predictive Analytics, Algorithms, Data Structures

SKILLS

Computer: Python, Excel, VBA, Bloomberg Terminal, familiarity with SQL

EXPERIENCE

SMBC, Associate July 2025 - Present

Validate daily intraday and end-of-day Risk/PnL and support book-close for the Fixed Income trading desk, working directly with traders to triage high-stakes issues under immediate deadlines and ensure books are properly closed every day. Proactively question and streamline core operational workflows, building Python and Excel tools wherever there's room for improvement.

Built end-to-end workflow automation including email-to-database pipelines, Teams alerting bots, production reconciliation scripts, and nightly job monitoring. Introduced daily standups and structured project tracking using Jira.

SMBC, Financial Analyst August 2024 - July 2025

Designed, implemented, and supported technical solutions to improve day-to-day trading activities, including finalizing daily PnL. Oversaw and reviewed accuracy of fixed income trading execution with a focus on reliable code. Collaborated with financial analysts, quantitative developers, and traders.

SMBC, Portfolio Analysis Intern December 2023 - August 2024

Automated daily manual tasks for the Fixed Income trading desk using Python and Excel. Supported and improved existing financial operations.

Octavate, Software Engineer Intern October 2023 - December 2023

Applied data analytics techniques to identify emerging artists using Python and DBeaver. Used a neural network face detection Python package (MTCNN) to identify artist features.

Undergraduate Researcher, AI and Predictive Analytics Lab October 2023 - May 2024

Studied creativity within AI with a group of graduate students under Professor Anasse Bari. Built a corpus of related works and developed a model to compare potential of existing LLMs.

USAMTS Contest Grader October 2023 - November 2024

Evaluated and graded student contest submissions in competitive high school mathematics. Provided individualized feedback critiquing methodology and format of solutions.

PROJECTS

Predicting DJIA prices using popular song lyrics in Python and RapidMiner August 2023

Explored the relationship between DJIA closing prices and popular song lyrics using sentiment analysis and predictive modeling. Used a Kaggle dataset to get all Billboard Hot 100 songs and the lyricsgenius Python package to obtain lyrics for each of the 3,100+ unique songs. Found a statistically significant correlation between the two.

ORGANIZATIONS

Treasurer of SLAM! Poetry, New York University January 2021 – September 2023

Recognized as a top club leader out of over 600 leaders based on involvement and experience.